

James Okonkwo

Director of Business Development – EMEA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Director of Business Development with 11 years of experience leading enterprise growth and strategic partnership initiatives across the EMEA region. Expert in navigating complex regulatory environments across UK, EU, and MEA markets and building senior C-suite relationships with global enterprises. Delivered \$75M+ in incremental ARR across EMEA through new logo acquisition and partner channel development.

EXPERIENCE

Director of Business Development – EMEA

Jan 2020 – Present

Workday, London, UK

- Led 8-person EMEA BD team responsible for new logo acquisition and strategic alliances across 30+ countries
- Delivered \$48M in new EMEA ARR over 3 years, growing regional contribution from 12% to 21% of global revenue
- Established Big-4 GSI co-sell programme (Deloitte, PwC, KPMG, EY) generating 40% of EMEA new logo pipeline
- Closed landmark £12M Workday Finance transformation with FTSE 50 retail conglomerate
- Opened MEA territory by signing anchor partnerships with 3 regional system integrators in UAE and Saudi Arabia

Senior Business Development Manager

Mar 2016 – Dec 2019

ServiceNow, London, UK

- Grew EMEA enterprise BD pipeline from £8M to £35M over 4 years through new logo and channel expansion
- Negotiated and signed 15 reseller and implementation partner agreements across UK, DACH, and Nordics
- Closed largest ServiceNow ITSM deal in the Nordics — £6.5M with a Scandinavian financial services group
- Managed regional sponsor relationships at 10+ EMEA industry events including ServiceNow Now at Work

Business Development Manager

Sep 2012 – Feb 2016

Zendesk, Dublin, Ireland

- Grew assigned EMEA territory from \$3M to \$11M in ARR through new business and expansion selling
- Built and managed 8 value-added reseller relationships across Western Europe

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

\$48M EMEA ARR Growth — Grew EMEA BD contribution from 12% to 21% of global Workday revenue over 3 years

£12M FTSE 50 Deal — Closed Workday's largest EMEA Finance transformation deal in FY2022

MEA Market Entry — Opened UAE and KSA markets; secured 3 anchor SI partners within 9 months

CORE SKILLS

Regional Expertise	EMEA market entry, UK/EU regulatory landscape, MEA expansion, Cross-cultural negotiation
BD & Alliances	Enterprise new logo, GSI co-sell, Reseller management, Channel conflict resolution
Leadership	Team management, Territory planning, Quota design, Executive stakeholder engagement
Tools	Salesforce, Clari, Gong, LinkedIn Sales Navigator, Highspot, Microsoft Dynamics
Languages	English (native), French (professional), Yoruba (native)

EDUCATION

M.B.A., International Business

London Business School

2010 – 2012

B.Sc. Business & Economics

University of Lagos

2005 – 2009

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- Certified Strategic Alliance Professional (CSAP)
- SPIN Selling Certified
- Workday Sales Specialist Certification
- Miller Heiman Strategic Selling